

OREGON CITY COURIER

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PROHIBITION

When honesty and partisanship conflict, which is to prevail? Apparently partisanship—if the supreme court of the state of Washington is any criterion.

The Washington prohibition law, which is quite similar in scope to the Oregon law, was carried before the supreme court of the Evergreen state on the ground that owing to errors in obedience to technicalities it was improperly passed. Thus a purely legal question was set before the court. The tribunal was not asked to decide whether the people meant to have prohibition; it was asked to determine if the statute had been correctly passed.

And what did the supreme court of Washington decide? It said that certain phases of the preliminaries of the popular vote on the law could not rightfully be reviewed by it, as it must presume that these preliminaries had been correctly done. It further remarked that the law, though it says it shall go into effect January 1, 1916, had actually gone into effect in December of last year. And the wise justices conclude that there is nothing the matter with the prohibition law.

Viewed in the abstract this seems a wonderfully weird decision and ruling. Asked to determine the technical correctness of the law, the court first says it cannot look into the manner of the preliminary steps used to bring about an election, and then (by looking at these very points) declares the law "legally" went into effect a year ago. "Though legally in effect its active operation was not to be until January 1, 1916." Isn't that a hot ruling for a supreme court justice to make?

Of course everybody knows at a glance what is back of this miracle play on the part of the Washington supreme court. The supreme court, knowing that a majority of the people desired to have the law they voted for go into effect, decided not to annul the law on technical points. The Oregon supreme court is understood by the Oregon "wets" to be likewise disposed to annul the Oregon law on technicalities, even were they asked so to do. No reflection is cast upon either court by this view of the case—instead it might be a matter for praise that the courts would refuse to attempt to annul the will of the people on the strength of mere technical errors by which the will of the people was expressed. In fact such an attitude on the part of the law sounds a good deal like the Millennium.

But there might have been other ways to do this than the method which the Washington supreme court took. If the Oregon supreme court has to face the same question, the Courier hopes it will find a more graceful and sensible way out of the dilemma.

And now that it is settled that Oregon's "prohibition statute" is not going to be imperiled in its workings by a "wet" state on the north; what of the law itself? This thought seems to have stirred the editorial brain of the Woodburn Independent, for last week that most estimable paper amidverted upon the Anderson law as follows, in part:

"In less than a month there will be 'legal prohibition' in the state of Oregon. That means that there will be no public liquor saloons regulated by law.

"In one sense it is a good thing that the saloon is abolished. It is an illegitimate business and has no right to exist in a peace-loving community. We have always considered it unconstitutional but difficult to get a favorable decision from our tribunals on that point.

"But while the saloon and breweries are to be driven from the state, we are given privileges that in our opinion are far more dangerous to the morals of the young man than the saloon. The saloon is eliminated, but the temptation is not removed.

"We have seen numerous young men who never drank when there were saloons, but became drunkards when they obtained liquor in surreptitious ways. It bears out well the old saying, 'Stolen fruit is the sweetest.'

"In addition to being permitted to

import liquor from other states, it is discovered that alcohol can be obtained from hard cider with a cream separator; silos will furnish alcohol; dandelion wine is easily made and is swifter in making a man crazy than whisky or beer; turning out Loganberry wine that 'does the act'—these do not clearly define 'prohibition' in the true sense of the word.

"It is a farce, pure and simple, and no prohibitionist can still his conscience until he joins those earnestly seeking to prohibit not only the manufacture and sale within the state, but importation. He should vociferously demand this and also see that when a lid is said to be resting tightly upon a community that it is actually the case.

"If there is a disgusting trait of character it is hypocrisy, fully exemplified in the career of those who are fully satisfied with having the saloon alone prohibited and the enactment by the legislature of a farce or comedy that, though laughable, is injurious to and threatens every community and home with disaster."

With which opinion the Courier would concur. Isn't it about time now that we started to do away with this "Schuebel prohibition" which we have, and adopt some real prohibition?

WHO SPOILED THE JOB?

Something has been worrying the Courier for quite a while, and we think it is about time now that we took you into our confidence about it. We note, by reading Genesis 1 and 27 that "God created man in His own image; in the image of God created He them."

That being the case, Adam must have been a fine gentleman, and Eve must likewise have been a most estimable lady. In fact the history we have of these two personages seems to convey the news that they were, during the greater part of their lives, quite perfect.

And the thing that has been worrying us for sometime is who jumped into this job and spoiled it?

For we have heard of quite a lot of people since Adam's time who haven't been created in the image of God—or at least they haven't been anything like the idea of God that we have had. And while it is true that all the little babies we have seen have been very cherubic and angelic, and may have resembled the Ruler of the Universe in many ways; it is also true that some men and women we have heard about never could have even got as near to the image of the Creator as the average baby.

Therefore somebody must have gotten in and spoiled the job. Not only has the job been spoiled in historic times, but the botch workman must still be active, for there are some folk of the present day who never could have been created in the same mould from which Adam and a lot of other fine gentlemen were poured.

Not to get too close to home, take for instance the gentlemen who are responsible for the present slaughterfest in Europe. What have they in common with God, or even the image of God? God, no matter whether the term be used by an orthodox Christian or by a worshipper of the Sacred Cow of Burma, is a force that creates, that bestows, that preserves. And this horror that is devastating Europe can hardly be said to be doing that—unless it is creating misery, bettering modes of suffering, and preserving hatred and degradation.

The war didn't "just happen." It was carefully led up to, carefully prepared, and as carefully launched as any great political scheme ever was launched. Men planned it, men projected it, and men are carrying it on.

Not only the poor helpless navies in the trenches and on the firing line, but "men higher up," decorated with titles and funny golden crowns though they may be, are persisting in continuing the war from motives that are worse than selfish—from motives that are criminal. Yet some of them flatter themselves by asking "God" to help them.

Was ever a greater travesty on the idea that "God created man in His own image?" And if it isn't a travesty on that, WHO BUTTED IN and spoiled the job?

cheapest quotations on work of this nature. The jobs have either been given to a certain favored printing office, or they have been quietly slipped to a friendly Portland shop. The records will show this, if they are consulted. A former taxpayers' committee expressly recommended that no county printing be done, and that no county stationery be purchased, unless competitive bids were sought from Clackamas county printing and stationery houses. And because competitive bids HAVE NOT BEEN SOUGHT, and because the work has been slipped to favored shops, the taxpayers' money has been lavishly spent. The remedy lies not in going to Portland; it lies in COMPELLING COUNTY OFFICIALS TO ASK FOR COMPETITIVE BIDS FROM CLACKAMAS COUNTY SHOPS.

Regarding the highschool tuition law, it is perhaps reasonable to suspect a nigger in the woodpile somewhere because of the wide variance of tuition fees charged by the different highschool districts. However, the law provides the manner in which these fees are to be fixed—and probing one district or another won't change the law. As the statute stands, figures can be juggled so that almost any fee desired may be charged.

And as to the employment of a county purchasing agent—the Lord deliver us. In theory a purchasing agent is worth his hire. Private cor-

The Courier isn't answering this question—it is just asking it. It is asking it in the hopes that somebody will shed a little light on the subject. We have been seeking light for 10, these many months; and can't find it. So we ask for help.

Who butted in and spoiled the job?

THE BUDGET AGAIN

A committee of taxpayers have viewed the county budget, and have submitted an advisory report. Not only have they dealt directly with the budget itself, but they have suggested that a county purchasing agent be added to the court house coterie, that the workings of the highschool tuition law be probed.

The budget committee was sincere in its recommendations. Aside from the above it tried to cure the road problem in these parts to a certain extent by advising a two-mile levy for hard surface roads. It suggested that county bridge work be handled in a lump levy, and it emphatically condemned the suggested purchase of the county fair grounds at Canby. It was unable to see why the county court was providing money for itself to stay in constant session for the entire year; it suggested an extra allowance for the prosecuting attorney during the first year of "prohibition," and it cut down the desires of the sheriff, thereby suggesting economy in that department of county business.

Regarding most of the recommendations, the Courier believes that general support will be given the taxpayers' committee. However, regarding some of them this paper believes that questions may be raised. Take the matter of county printing, for instance. During the past year there has been no effort on the part of a number of county officials to get the

porations employ them, and find that they save money for the firm. But no municipality, no county and no state has yet been able to employ a purchasing agent and effect by the system a saving proportionate to the salary. Has the taxpayers' committee any reason to believe that Clackamas county can accomplish a miracle in this line?

PORK

There has been quite a little in the papers and magazines recently about "pork," but pork wasn't referred to at all. What was meant was graft. These remarks, however, are not about graft that is called "pork," but are about real pork.

Last week a Clackamas county stock raiser sent 1195 pounds of pork to a Portland wholesaler, and after taking one good look at the meat the wholesaler called the city health officer. The doctor took a look at the pork and then confiscated the entire shipment.

The only thing the matter with the pork was that the animals from which it came had been suffering from hog cholera.

Over in Yakima county, Washington, some years ago, the state health authorities went through the district with an avenging hand and shot and poisoned several thousand hogs that were suffering from this disease. They preferred to kill the stock on the ranch rather than run the risk of the meat getting into the cities and being sold by butchers who might be careless. "Careless" is a nice and polite word to use.

It probably would have been better for hog raising in Clackamas county if similar practices had been done here. When half a ton of Clackamas county if similar practices had

marks about the proposed sale of the old city filtration plant by the county seat, and about the legal questions more or less intimately concerned in this sale. Right here, however, the Courier desires to ask why there should be any vast rush about this transaction.

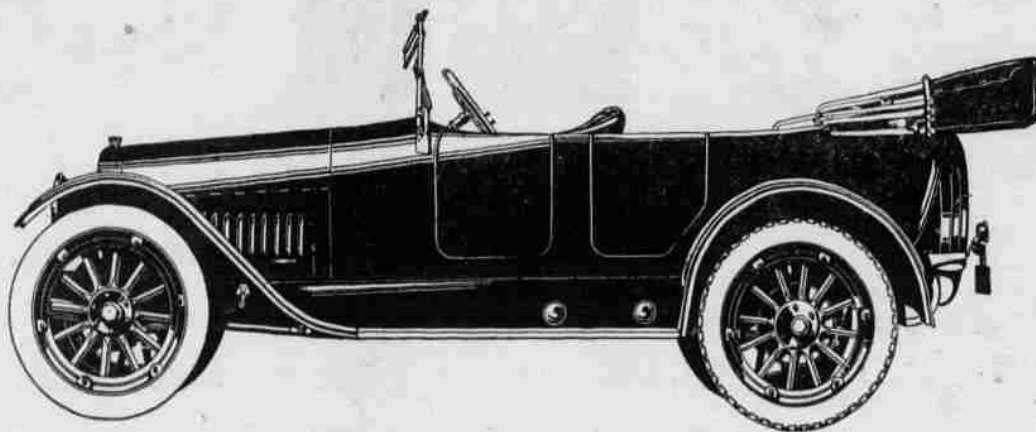
The Hawley mill people say they desire to enlarge their plant and provide work for 200 additional employees. Such a plan ought to have the endorsement of the city and of every citizen. BUT the plan is not going to be constructed before Christmas, yet there seems to be a desire on the part of some of the people who are aiding Mr. Hawley to "railroad" the sale of the old filtration plant without giving the council an opportunity to see what else it may be selling aside from the old water plant.

It appears that the city has somewhere a water right that is worth not less than \$68,000. This water right is tied up with certain land to which the city has title. Whether this land is the land upon which the filtration plant stands seems to be a matter for question. If it is this land, it would not be good business for the city to sell a \$68,000 water right for \$20,000, even if it did give employment to 200 more men.

The Courier has no objection to an increase of industry in these parts. It has no objection to the sale of the old filtration plant, if that is all which is to be sold. But if the deal carries with it the sale of the water right, or if the deal in any way clouds title to this water right, then the Courier does not think it would be good judgment to sell the plant. The only way to decide this question is to examine into the thing thoroughly, and this cannot be done over night.

The thing for the city to do first of all, it seems to the Courier, is to

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of '16

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been done here. When half a ton of Clackamas pork is condemned in one lump in Portland, it is sure to put a considerable prejudice in the minds of pork buyers every time Clackamas pork is mentioned. Possibly the man who shipped in this diseased pork didn't know that it was unfit for food—but even in that case Clackamas pork is going to have its troubles getting to market now for sometime. The buying public is suspicious, and the publicity given this Clackamas diseased pork is going to make it hard to sell good pork from this section until the public forgets.

Since so much bad pork was shipped out of Clackamas county, it would be a good thing, in the mind of the Courier, if Clackamas county hog-raisers asked the state livestock officials to drop down and inspect their stock. If there is any more hog cholera in these parts, it ought to be found out NOW, and further shipments of such meat stopped. The only way to keep up the reputation of this county for growing good beef and pork, and for supplying good dairy and other products, is TO KEEP EVERYTHING FIRST CLASS ALL THE TIME.

This is the time to look into this matter, and it ought to be done.

WHAT'S THE HURRY?

On another page of this issue of the Courier will be found some re-

find out the status of its holdings in the southern end of the municipality. Then it will know what these holdings are worth. Just as mere real estate, the city filtration plant site is not worth \$20,000; and when the Hawley company offers that sum for it, it is but natural that some suspicion be aroused. Let us proceed slowly in this matter and see what it is that the city might sell; and after we know what it is, then we can figure on the advisability of selling.

There is no rush in the matter—a month more or less to look into the question will not spoil the plans of the Hawley company; for that concern wants a sixty-day option before it decides whether or not it will buy. Let us not forget to hurry, and see what it is that lies at the end of Main street.

MORE ABOUT JITNEYS

It is some time since the county seat has been excited about jitneys, and the "jits" are still running without paying special license fees. When certain noble councilmen were endeavoring to "protect the people" and chase the Portland jitneys from competing with the interurban line, the statement was made by the friends of the automobile transports that they were fulfilling a want, and that if the interurban company really wanted to put the "jits" out of business, they could do it by bettering car service.

Do You Read Labels?

Domestic science teachers and food authorities are urging the housewife to carefully read the labels on all food articles.

The laws of most States compel food manufacturers to print the ingredients of their products on the label, and this enables consumers to distinguish healthful foods from those which may be deleterious.

High-grade baking powders are made of pure cream of tartar, derived from grapes. Royal Baking Powder is a type of the highest grade. It is healthful beyond a doubt and the safest and best to use.

The low-grade baking powders are made from alum, a mineral acid salt, or phosphate of lime.

Consumers can learn the character of the baking powder by referring to the label, which must state whether the contents include cream of tartar, alum or phosphate.

ROYAL BAKING POWDER CO.
New York

Now it appears that this is true. For some months past there has been a jitney operating between Milwaukie and Baker's Bridge. Within the past two weeks the Carver line started operation over that part of its line running between Baker's Bridge and Milwaukie. All points reached by the former jitney were given two trains a day—that is, all points except Clackamas station. And what happened?

The jitney quit. The jitney now runs to Clackamas from Milwaukie, and to Clackamas from Gray's Crossing. But it doesn't attempt to compete with the Carver line.

Reasoning by analogy, the Portland Oregon City jitneys survive solely because there is no other means of transportation that is convenient to the traveling public. Why, then, should any of the city fathers of the county seat want to oust the "jits" for "the protection of the people." Judging by what is happening on the other jitney line, the people can protect themselves with readiness, dispatch and success when the opportunity is offered.

"Uncle Billy" Mattoon is willing to be re-elected to the county court. It is nice to know that at least one person is willing.

If the city sells its water plant and the pipeline breaks, would it be a case of "water, water everywhere, and not a drop to drink?"

Mr. Cox appears to have developed a new kind of vote. To his famous "silent vote" he has added a kind that changes after midnight.

They are clipping "aigrettes" again in Portland. Funny, isn't it, how the inspectors make business for the milliners about Christmas time.

Thank goodness for one thing: we now know that horses which lived a million years ago had only one toe to the hind foot, instead of three.

Eight more days to Christmas, and on one of them the stores will be closed. Have you done your Christmas shopping early at your home store yet?

Now the girls are wearing mirrors in their bonnets so they can see what men are doing behind them. Some women don't need mirrors to tell what men are doing.

It is noteworthy that Chief of Police Ed Shaw put the skids under "punch boards" in the county seat before the esteemed "city attorney" knew the law was being violated.

Austria has now had a taste of Uncle Sam's displeasure. In time all the European war-mad nations will learn that the United States has its own ideas about things.

The Oregon building at San Francisco is going to be a clubhouse for army officers. Not so very different from being a clubhouse for members of the Oregon commission, after all.

Oregon Christmas trees are making the world gladder this holiday season; and Clackamas county seems to be contributing her share of the

"magic pines that bloom with light."

Already the Carver line is getting "pursé proud," and now stops only at designated stations. Before prosperity hit it, the trains would stop anywhere along the line to pick up a fare.

The fact that a 17-year old boy committed suicide because of his infatuation for a married woman seems to indicate that there is something wrong with the training this youth received.

The Chinese president having expressed a willingness to become emperor, rumors of revolution are again to be heard. It is too far along in civilization's calendar for emperors to be very popular.

A New York humorist declares that one of the parting gifts to Henry Ford, delivered aboard his chartered ocean greyhound, was a caged squirrel. That strikes us as being true wit, to say the least.

The extreme of "dramatic license" appeared on county seat billboards last week, when advertisements of a play set in the Blue Ridge mountains showed pictures of snow-capped peaks. The artists who designed the posters must have hit the Blue Ridge in a heavy blizzard.

A fair admirer told Rex Lampman, who writes dished funny stuff for a Portland paper, that he resembled the Savior. Maybe that was what Rex was thinking of when he wrote his poem in which he said Henry Ford resembled the same Person.

Dean Collins, of the "Crawfish," says that if Portland doesn't get "parity rates," the government would send troops to Seattle and Tacoma in case of an invasion on the West Coast. We wonder the Oregonian permits Dean to write such gentle satire in its pages.

Citrolax
Best thing for constipation, sour stomach, lazy liver and sluggish bowels. Stops a sick headache almost at once. Gives a most thorough and satisfactory flushing—no pain, no nausea. Keep your system cleansed, sweet and wholesome.—R. H. Weihecht, Salt Lake City, Utah, writes: "I find Citrolax the best laxative I ever used. Does not gripe—no unpleasant after-effects."—Jones Drug Co.

JACKSON, MISS., MAN
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